

ESSENTIAL

Financial Requirements Overview

What “sufficient funds” means for a B-2 application, and how to evidence it

There's no official minimum bank balance

Unlike some other visa categories, U.S. consular guidance does not publish a specific minimum bank balance for B-2 applicants. Any number you see quoted online as “the official minimum” is an unofficial estimate, not a published rule. What actually matters is whether your evidence convinces the officer you can cover the trip without needing to work and without becoming a public burden.

The Premium tier's Financial Proof Calculator gives you a reasonable planning estimate based on trip length and travel style - useful for your own budgeting, but treat it as a planning tool, not an official threshold.

What “sufficient funds” actually means

- You can cover flights, accommodation, and daily living costs for the trip's full length
- Your income or savings are consistent with your stated travel budget - a large trip funded by a small, static account looks inconsistent
- You're not relying on working in the U.S. to fund the visit

Acceptable evidence

- Bank statements (recent, showing a consistent balance history rather than a single snapshot)
- Pay stubs or an employment letter confirming income
- Fixed deposits or investment statements
- If someone else is funding the trip: their financial evidence, a letter explaining the relationship and their commitment to sponsor the visit, and proof of their own status/ties

Red flags officers commonly watch for

- A large, unexplained lump-sum deposit shortly before the application - build funds up naturally over time where possible, and be ready to explain any large deposit if asked
- An account balance that doesn't match the applicant's stated income or occupation
- Financial evidence that covers the trip on paper but leaves the account empty afterward, with no explanation of ongoing means